

Dye sublimation

This technique is used by certain printers to transfer dye on a medium such as paper, plastic card or even fabric using heat

The new core

Rumours have been spreading about Intel releasing a new CPU: The Core i7 960. Intel was supposed to have released a new Core i7 950 CPU at the end of May, but those plans did not see fruition

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Taking photos is just half the fun. Who doesn't like to print pictures of loved ones and important events, and pass them around? At the same time we desire good, if not the best, quality of print. For these purposes a new range of inkjet printers has emerged, known as photo inkjet printers. These photo printers are suitable, not only for budding photographers, but also for people shooting family reunions and outings with friends and families.

There are two types of photo printers: compact and well, not

so compact. Compact photo printers are used mainly to churn out instant snapshots with standard print sizes, usually of 4 x 6 inches and not larger than 5 x 7 inches. The non-compact photo printers can print photo quality images on A4 sheets and some even print on A3 sheets of paper. There are even photo printers used for business purposes that give quality prints at sizes starting from 24-inches right up to 60-inches, but we are not testing these here. We have kept this test specific to compact and non-compact photo printers.

We received products from Canon, Epson and HP for this test. We also made contact

with Sony, as it does have some compact photo printers, but the company did not want to participate in this comparative review. Why, we don't know; you can draw your own conclusions.

Canon Pixma iP1980

The Pixma iP 1980 is an entry level inkjet from Canon. The design is rather plain and simple with the colour of the body being entirely black. There are only two buttons on this printer: one to power on the device and the other to clear any paper jams.

Since this is just a basic photo printer, its connectivity is also very limited and the only option you have is to connect

via a USB cable. There are no ports for networking, no card reader and not even a USB port for PictBridge support.

The body of the iP1980 is predominantly made of plastic and does not feel that sturdy. There is no locking or clicking mechanism present to stop the lid from accidentally being lifted, as happened quite often with us when moving this printer around.

The printer is easy to setup and the iP1980 uses two cartridges, black and colour. Once the head alignment page is printed you have to manually adjust the settings and select the boxes with the least number of lines.

The paper is loaded from the

snap it, print it

Taking photos is just half the fun. Here we look at the second half – printing them out to share with friends and family. Read on to find out the best photo printers out there in the Indian market

